



PROGRESS REPORT

Digital divides: progress report, 2025-09-01 to 2026-09-02

Edition of 2026-09-02 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

2 places. Every table below is carried verbatim from that place's own progress report; nothing is written here.

AFRICA · SOUTHERN AFRICA

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-02	MOVEMENT
Smartphone shipments and entry-level affordability	Three consecutive years of shipment growth to the second quarter of 2025, with aggressive price reductions in that quarter	Shipments fell 7% year on year in the second quarter of 2026, the first decline in three years, with the sub-\$100 segment down 34% - nearly three million units - and the average selling price up \$41 to \$202; the research house forecasts a 26% decline for 2026, memory now accounts for nearly 60% of the bill of materials for sub-\$400 devices and over 64% under \$99, and an entry-level handset can cost up to 73% of a low-income adult's monthly income in sub-Saharan Africa	REGRESSED
Women and girls digital-inclusion accelerator	BASELINE NOT HELD	An industry-body accelerator backed by two private foundations opened its next call for digital-inclusion solutions for women and girls across India and sub-Saharan Africa, with a grant amount listed at INR 42,000,000	Baseline not held

Southern Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-02	MOVEMENT
COMESA Regional Digital Inclusion Strategy	Did not exist	In drafting under the World Bank-supported IDEA programme, with consultation on affordable connectivity and devices, skills gaps, accessibility and digital trust; no draft, drafter or adoption date published	ADVANCED

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-09-02
CURRENT EDITION	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/topics/include-divides/include-divides-progress.html
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/topics/include-divides/include-divides-progress-2026-09-02.pdf
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Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.